9.15 Fat Embolism Syndrome*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I suddenly feel short of breath." **Objective** • Long-bone fracture 2 days ago • SpO_2 86% • Petechiae across the chest • Confused	**ACTUAL** Impaired gas exchange related to fat emboli in the pulmonary circulation as evidenced by hypoxemia, dyspnea and petechiae.	• SpO_2 94% or above.	• Give high-flow oxygen. • Sit him upright. • Request urgent review and prepare for ventilation. • Move the fractured limb as little as possible.	• Goal reached at target SpO_2.
Subjective • Family say, "He is confused." **Objective** • Disoriented • Restless	**ACTUAL** Acute confusion related to cerebral fat emboli and hypoxemia as evidenced by disorientation.	• Oriented as oxygenation improves.	• Carry out neurological checks. • Keep safety measures in place. • Give oxygen to target.	• Met once he is oriented.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Hypoxemia • Tachycardia	**RISK** Risk for decreased cardiac output as evidenced by risk factors: right ventricular strain.	• Vital signs stay stable.	• Keep ECG and vital signs on continuous monitoring. • Report hypotension. • Give oxygen.	• Achieved while he remains stable.

*References for this care plan: [32], [35], [106], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.